

ACCT 322: Financial Reporting and Analysis II

Fall 2026 Syllabus

Gang (Ernest) Pan, Ph.D.

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1 Instructor & Course Information

- **Instructor:** Gang (Ernest) Pan, Ph.D., Assistant Professor of Accounting
- **Office & Hours:** College of Accountancy 241 | Tue & Thu 03:30 PM – 04:45 PM (By appointment only: [Appointment Link](#))
- **Contact:** Email: gpan@uakron.edu (Please include “#AcctFun” in subject) | Phone: 314-778-0609
- **Class Time & Location:** Section 801: TTh | 5:15 PM – 6:30 PM | CBA 131

2 Pre-requisites

ACCT 201 and ACCT 321 (completion with a minimum grade of C is mandatory; otherwise, permission is required.)

3 Tutoring Services

To support your learning outside regular business hours, you have complimentary access to **Tutor.com**, an online, on-demand tutoring service. Our class is fully supported by this platform. You can access on-demand tutoring at any time by navigating to the “My Tools” tab on the course page in Brightspace.

4 Course Text

Spiceland, J. David, Mark W. Nelson, Wayne B. Thomas, and Jennifer Winchel. *Intermediate Accounting*. 2025 Release. New York: McGraw-Hill Irwin, 2025.

- You will need the corresponding McGraw-Hill Education Connect® access to this textbook for all homework, assignments, and exams.
- A print text is optional since Connect® contains the full reading experience.

*This course is part of our course material delivery program, Akron ALL-IN Book Bundle. The bookstore will provide each student with a convenient package containing all required physical materials, and all digitally delivered materials for this course will be integrated into Brightspace. You should have received an email from the bookstore confirming the materials provided for each of your courses and asking you to select how you would like to receive any printed components (in-store pickup or home delivery). If you have not done so already, please confirm your fulfillment preference so the bookstore can prepare your materials. For more information about Akron ALL-IN Book Bundle, please go to uakron.edu/bookbundle.

**I may assign additional reading materials as the course progresses.

5 Course Objectives and Learning Goals

In this course, you will continue your journey in mastering accounting. Accounting is often called the language of business. To truly master a new language, one must practice it within the specific scenarios where it is spoken—just as learning vocabulary for dining requires engaging in the setting of a restaurant. Similarly, to learn the language of business, you must immerse yourself in the background of business itself. This course will therefore delve into the real-world business activities, practices, and transactions that financial accounting describes. We will explore the key concepts, theories, and mechanics of financial accounting, with a focus on the financial accounting of publicly traded firms, building on what you have learned in ACCT 321.

5.1 Topics

- Compared to ACCT 321, this course covers topics that remain common across most businesses but involve greater complexity.
- These topics will challenge your understanding of fundamental financial statement elements—assets, liabilities, equity, revenues, expenses, gains, and losses.
- As we progress, you will see that even complex transactions can often be broken down into simpler components. For instance, lease contracts share similarities with purchases made through installment notes.
- Additionally, we will explore more areas governed by detailed GAAP regulations rather than intuitive accounting logic. While these rules may initially seem arbitrary, we will examine the reasoning behind them by considering the dynamics of accounting standard-setting.

- Two touchstone topics in this course are accounting for income taxes and the statement of cash flows:
 - Accounting for income taxes is among the most error-prone areas for public companies, representing more than 25% of all SEC comment letters.
 - The statement of cash flows requires a comprehensive understanding of cash flow implications for nearly every transaction we cover, as well as a solid grasp of the relation between cash accounting and accrual accounting.
 - I take pride in my students' strong mastery of these topics compared to many other accountants.

5.2 Connections to Other Courses and CPA Exam

- This course builds upon the knowledge you acquired in ACCT 201 and ACCT 321. A weak foundation could lead to negative consequences and hinder your learning experience in this class. Unfortunately, I cannot provide comprehensive re-education of all the material you should be familiar with at this stage. To help you identify areas for improvement, a self-diagnose test will be provided. If you find that a prerequisite concept is not well understood, I strongly recommend seeking tutoring at any point.
- You will have the opportunity to revisit the topics covered in this class in ACCT 408: International Financial Reporting & Analysis, from an IFRS perspective rather than US GAAP.
- Your understanding of key concepts such as the entity assumption, the distinction between net income and other comprehensive income, and the basics of financial derivatives will be crucial for your success in ACCT 420: Advanced Financial Reporting and Analysis.
- All the topics covered in this class will be tested in the Financial Accounting and Reporting (FAR) section of the Certified Public Accountant (CPA) exam. Some technical accounting and reporting topics, economic analyses I demonstrate, and financial decision-making will also be part of the Business Analysis and Reporting (BAR) section of the CPA exam.
- Although the topics covered in this class are relevant to CPA exams, it's important to note that it's not an alternative to your exam preparation courses. The fact that you will be encountering these topics for the first time makes it challenging to achieve CPA-level proficiency within the time allotted for a single semester. However, the study materials provided in this class are comprehensive and even exceed the requirements of CPA exams. It's a vast repository of knowledge that ambitious students can explore. CPA exam preparation classes are typically offered in most master of accountancy programs. For instance, the MSA program at the University of Akron provides two Professional Colloquium courses that cover the Financial Accounting Reporting (FAR) and Auditing and Attestation (AUD) sessions.

5.3 Professionalism

Success in this course depends heavily on the active effort and dedication you invest beyond class hours. As future business leaders, you are expected to demonstrate professional manners and diligence.

To maintain a productive learning environment:

- **Classroom Decorum:** Please limit the use of electronic devices to class-related activities and minimize irrelevant chatter. To facilitate an engaging environment, the instructor reserves the right to assign seats.
- **Active Engagement:** Listening, observing, participating, and writing are keys to internalizing the material. During each class, we will solve practice questions together, and you are responsible for taking proper notes. Experience shows that students who attend and actively engage in lectures achieve significantly better grades.
- **Course Policies:** You must adhere strictly to all course policies, attend classes regularly, and complete all out-of-class assignments and readings with care and integrity.

Please note that students with limited exposure to or interest in the technical aspects of financial accounting will find the depth of this course highly challenging. Diligent preparation and professional commitment are necessary to successfully navigate this material.

5.4 AI Proficiency

As the world embraces the Generative AI (GenAI) era, this class explores the potential of GenAI to enhance the capabilities of accountants. While GenAI can assist accountants in various tasks, it cannot replace the importance of in-person interactions in client relations and critical thinking. This course goes beyond mere bookkeeping; it prepares you for long-term career success by emphasizing critical thinking through in-class discussions. By the end of the course, you'll gain a comprehensive understanding of fundamental accounting principles used in external financial reporting, learn how to effectively utilize AI tools, and develop your critical thinking skills and leadership abilities.

5.5 Coverage of International Financial Reporting Standards (IFRS)

Each chapter in the text makes appropriate references to IFRS and its relevance to the chapter material. You may review the green-colored IFRS boxes in each chapter. While US GAAP will be the basis for our discussions of financial reporting in this class, knowledge of IFRS is necessary for professional accounting competency. It is important to be aware

of the concepts surrounding IFRS, and the relevant differences between US GAAP and IFRS. In-depth discussions on IFRS are covered in ACCT 408.

6 Mission Statement of the Daverio School of Accountancy

The George W. Daverio School of Accountancy provides students with the educational background to become competent and responsible accounting professionals. With a rich history of (i) accounting education that serves both traditional and non-traditional students and (ii) close relationships with the professional community in Northern Ohio, we emphasize undergraduate and masters-level education with an applied focus. The School offers a Bachelor of Science degree in Accountancy, a Master of Science in Accountancy, and a Master of Taxation.

The School stresses a learning environment that places primary importance on student success through effective teaching, complemented by faculty scholarship, interaction with the professional community, and service.

7 Class Format and Activities

- This class is entirely in-person. An asynchronous version of the class is offered during one of the five-week summer sessions. However, a full semester of learning is highly recommended. The class materials are adequate, even if you need to study them at your own pace. If you require lecture videos, please contact your instructor.
- Out of our class time, 40 percent is dedicated to lectures, 30 percent to in-class exercises, and the remaining 30 percent is allocated to discussions. During these discussions, you'll practice Feynman's method of learning, which aims to enhance your critical thinking and business communication skills.

8 Attendance Policy

According to the undergraduate bulletin of the University of Akron, a student is expected to attend all class meetings for which the student is registered. A student may be dropped from a course in the current term by the dean if absence is repeated and the instructor recommends this action; a student can gain re-admission only with permission of both the instructor and the dean. A student dropped from a course receives an "F" which counts as work attempted whenever grade-point ratio calculations are made.

In this course:

- You will be fully responsible for your own actions. Your instructor does not take responsibility for addressing the increased chronic absenteeism that occurred after the COVID-19 pandemic.
- Your attendance will not be directly factored into your point grade, but attendance will be recorded and noticed.
- To align with the university's policy, your instructor may call students to answer questions if no one volunteers.
- If multiple absences are detected, along with other evidence indicating that the learning goals will not be achieved, enforcement action in accordance with the policy described above will be taken.

9 Grading Policy

A total of 1,000 points is available to be earned in this course. While points are the primary basis for course grading, final letter grades are also subject to exam performance caps, the straight 'A' grade cap, and discretionary grade bump policies. The point-earning activities are summarized in the table below:

Table 1

Activity	Number	Individual Points	Total Points
AI Accounting Analytics	6*	30	180
Pre-Class Assignments	7*	5	35
Post-Class Assignments	7*	15	105
Mid-term Exams	2	200	400
Comprehensive Final Exam	1	280	280
Total Possible Points			1000

To receive a particular letter grade, students must earn the minimum number of points required for that grade (refer to the grading scale below).

*Reflects the 6 highest scores out of 7 total AI Accounting Analytics assignments, and the 7 highest scores out of 8 total Pre-Class and Post-Class assignments.

Table 2

Letter Grade	% Range	Point Range	Letter Grade	% Range	Point Range
A	92 to 100	920 – 1000	C	72 to 77.9	720 – 779.9
A-	90 to 91.9	900 – 919.9	C-	70 to 71.9	700 – 719.9
B+	88 to 89.9	880 – 899.9	D+	68 to 69.9	680 – 699.9

Letter Grade	% Range	Point Range	Letter Grade	% Range	Point Range
B	82 to 87.9	820 – 879.9	D	62 to 67.9	620 – 679.9
B-	80 to 81.9	800 – 819.9	D-	60 to 61.9	600 – 619.9
C+	78 to 79.9	780 – 799.9	F	Below 60%	Below 600

*I reserve the right to modify the letter grade based on each student's individual performance.

9.1 Important Notes on Letter Grade Assignment

Meeting the minimum point thresholds listed in Table 2 is a necessary condition but does not guarantee the corresponding letter grade. The following additional rules apply:

1. **Exam Performance Caps:** To ensure core competency, obtaining a score below 60% on any of the three exams is considered failing that exam. If you fail one or more exams, your final course letter grade will be restricted (capped) as follows, regardless of how many total points you accumulate in the course:
 - **Failing 1 exam** (scoring < 120 points on Midterm 1 or 2, or < 168 points on the Final Exam): Your final letter grade is capped at a maximum of **B**.
 - **Failing 2 exams:** Your final letter grade is capped at a maximum of **C**.
 - **Failing 3 exams:** Your final letter grade is capped at a maximum of **F** (automatic failure of the course).
2. **'A' Grade Cap & Allocation:** The maximum number of straight 'A' grades awarded in this course is capped at 25% of the total registered student enrollment plus 4, rounded down (e.g., if there are 30 enrolled students, $30 \times 25\% + 4 = 11.5 \rightarrow 11$ straight 'A's maximum). Since earning ≥ 920 points does not guarantee a straight 'A', the available 'A' slots will be allocated using the following priority hierarchy (within each tier, students are ranked based on their total points):
 - **Priority Tier 1 (Qualitative Excellence + Point Excellence):** Slots are first allocated to students who already meet the point threshold for a straight 'A' (≥ 920 points), have never failed an exam, **and** also receive a discretionary grade bump.
 - **Priority Tier 2 (Qualitative Grade Bumps to 'A'):** Next, slots are allocated to students who earned an 'A-' through points (900 to 919.9 points) and receive a discretionary grade bump that raises them to a straight 'A'.
 - **Priority Tier 3 (Points Ranking / No Grade Bump):** Next, slots are allocated to students who met the point threshold for a straight 'A' (≥ 920 points) and

have never failed an exam, but **did not** receive any grade bump, provided they maintained satisfactory class participation.

- **Priority Tier 4 (Poor Participation / Lowest Priority):** Lastly, slots are allocated to students who met the point threshold for a straight 'A' (≥ 920 points) and have never failed an exam, but had poor class participation. These students are the most likely to be restricted to an **A-** if the straight 'A' cap is exceeded.
- *Note:* Students who meet the points requirement for an 'A' (≥ 920 points) but are not allocated a straight 'A' due to the cap will receive an **A-**.

Discretionary Grade Bumps: At the professor's discretion, students may receive a grade bump (e.g., moving up one grade step, such as B to B+ or D- to D) to reward outstanding qualitative performance. This includes:

- Exceeding expectations on challenging assignments.
- Expressing consistently insightful ideas during class discussions.
- Making notable contributions that facilitate the learning experience for everyone.

Important constraints on Grade Bumps: 1. **Exam Cap Override:** A grade bump **cannot** bypass the grade limits established by the Exam Performance Caps (e.g., if a student fails one exam, a grade bump cannot raise their grade past the B maximum cap). 2. **'A' Grade Cap Interaction:** If a discretionary grade bump raises a student's grade from an A- to a straight A, this will occupy one of the available straight 'A' slots under the 25% + 4 cap.

9.2 Explanation of Grading Items

- You will be informed of your progress to 1,000 points at any time in the gradebook.
- Active participation in class is crucial for enhancing the learning experience. A lack of voluntary discussion will negatively impact your letter grade. To facilitate participation, please bring a name tent to each class.
- **Pre-Class Assignments:** For each chapter, you will complete a Pre-Class Assignment before the lecture. These assignments require you to watch the designated videos and complete the corresponding exercises on the **Sharpen** study app. However, please note that a more comprehensive and thorough preparation before each lecture requires reading the corresponding book chapter. Each Pre-Class Assignment is worth 5 points. The seven highest scores of the eight Pre-Class Assignments will be counted into your gradebook, and the lowest grade will be dropped.
- **Post-Class Assignments:** For each chapter, you will complete a Post-Class Assignment. Each Post-Class Assignment is worth 15 points and is open book. These assignments have unlimited attempts, and I will take the highest score. Solutions are provided after the due date, and I will not answer specific questions from the

assignment until after the due date. The seven highest scores of the eight Post-Class Assignments will be counted into your gradebook, and the lowest grade will be dropped.

- **AI Accounting Analytics:** As mentioned in the “Generative AI (GenAI) Policy” section, there are seven AI Accounting Analytics assignments in total, each worth 30 points. To provide flexibility for unforeseen circumstances, your lowest score among these seven assignments will be dropped when calculating your final grade.
- **Midterm exams:** Two 1.5-hour-long midterm exams will be given during the term, each worth 200 points. Additionally, a two-hour-long comprehensive final exam will be given at the end of the term, worth 280 points.
- **Exam rules:**
 - All exams are closed book. You are NOT allowed to use the internet to search for answers or discuss the exam with others.
 - Take-home exams: You must log into Connect® to complete the exams. Make-up exams are not offered, and a missed examination will result in a score of zero, unless excused by the instructor in advance.
 - Exam availability: Exams will be available on exam days from 8:00 AM to 11:59 PM. You may start the exam at any time during these hours but must complete it by 11:59 PM. Submissions after 11:59 PM will be subject to the hourly late submission penalty.
 - Proctoring: Proctoring functions are enabled for exams. If you have concerns about the recording function, please inform the instructor in advance, and an alternative in-person exam may be arranged.
 - A practice exam will be provided before each exam. All practice exams are due two days before the actual exam to allow time for using the study mode, which enables you to practice using different sets of numbers for supported questions. A small amount of bonus points is attached to each practice exam if you complete it early.
 - Exam Content: The exam questions are drawn from a limited pool of our in-class exercises, post-class assignments, practice exams, and previous exams conducted during this session.
- **Bonus points:** You will have several opportunities to earn bonus points:
 - A small amount of bonus points is attached to each practice exam if you complete it early (based on the number of questions completed).
 - Bonus assignments may be assigned during the semester. These assignments require you to go beyond the classroom to investigate firms’ real-life disclosures. They aim to connect our class discussions with practical applications. The points assigned to each bonus assignment vary. However, completing a bonus assignment is not a viable solution to compensate for unsatisfactory performance in exams and routine assignments.

9.3 Late Submission and Make-Up Policy

These policies apply across the board to all assignments and evaluations (including exams) in this course:

- **Due Date Responsibility:** You are responsible for monitoring the due dates for all assignments and exams on the course calendar.
- **No Make-ups or Individual Extensions:** There are **NO make-ups** for graded assignments or exams, and the instructor does not offer individual extensions for any due dates.
- **Late Submission Penalty:** If an assignment or exam due date has passed, you can still submit it. However, your grade will be discounted for late submission by **1% for every hour** that passes after the due time. Consequently, you will lose all points for the assignment or exam after 100 hours.
- **Dropped Grade Policy:** The purpose of dropping the lowest score(s) on routine assignments (e.g., Pre-Class and Post-Class Assignments) is to accommodate unanticipated emergency situations, personal illnesses, or schedule conflicts that you may encounter during the semester. Additional accommodations should adhere to the guidelines provided by the accessibility office.

10 Generative AI (GenAI) Policy

- GenAI is revolutionizing the world at an unprecedented pace. AI tools are incredibly powerful in enhancing the learning process and automating repetitive or mechanical tasks. Regardless of individual opinions on AI, it's undeniable that employers seek talent who can effectively utilize AI to boost productivity.
- In this class, you will not only use AI as your tutor but also gain practical experience in how AI can assist accounting professionals in researching accounting policies and extracting financial information from publicly traded companies through a series of AI and accounting analytics assignments.
- These assignments will also encourage you to reflect on the limitations of GenAI, the potential harm of AI slop, and its impact on human cognitive abilities.
- To prevent you from outsourcing all your work to AI, your response to the last question of each AI assignment must be handwritten and submitted in person within a week after the assignment's due date. Failure to comply will result in a zero for the assignment.
- The inappropriate or unethical use of such technologies will violate the Code of Student Conduct, which includes cheating, plagiarism, fabrication, unauthorized collaboration, misrepresentation, and gaining an unfair advantage. For instance, it is not permitted to use any GenAI assistance during exams.

11 Tips for Success

You will succeed in this class by carefully following the instructions and policies. However, intrinsic motivation will benefit you in the long run. There are numerous books and people you can seek advice from; therefore, I will cover what I deem most essential below:

1. Your identity will shape the approaches you take and the outcomes you achieve. Clearly identify who you are or who you want to be, and find a strong connection between that vision and the subject you are learning (in our case, financial accounting). However, setting an identity that is too difficult to achieve may harm your mental wellness.
2. Be monomaniacal about the things that align with your identity. Monomania is defined as “a condition in which someone is extremely interested in one thing, in a way that is not normal” (Cambridge Dictionary). I argue that it can be a perfectly normal state where you enjoy the “flow state” and achieve professionalism.
3. Do not be afraid of failing when seeking help. Steve Jobs testified to this point (watch it [here](#)). If you know a strong classmate or friend who can help you understand financial accounting better than I can, seek their help and return the favor by helping others. If I do not reply to you quickly enough, reach out again and remind me. Nothing will happen if you sit back and do not ask at all.
4. Additionally, it is important to note that the contents of this class are interconnected through the fundamental accounting equation (i.e., $\text{Assets} = \text{Liabilities} + \text{Equity}$; also known as the ALE equation). Therefore, please find answers to your questions before we move on to the next topics to prevent confusion from snowballing.

12 Course Calendar

Table 3 — Fall 2026 (Tuesdays & Thursdays; no class Nov 24 & 26 — Thanksgiving)

Week	Date	In Class	Assignments
1	Tue. 08/25	Course Introduction	
1	Thu. 08/27	Ch. 6: (BAR) Revenue Recognition (Session 1)	Pre Ch. 6 (due 08/27) AI 1 (due 08/30)
2	Tue. 09/01	Ch. 6: (BAR) Revenue Recognition (Session 2)	
2	Thu. 09/03	Ch. 6: (BAR) Revenue Recognition (Session 3)	Post Ch. 6 (due 09/06)
3	Tue. 09/08	Ch. 12: Investment (Session 1)	Pre Ch. 12 (due 09/08)
3	Thu. 09/10	Ch. 12: Investment (Session 2)	AI 2 (due 09/13)

Week	Date	In Class	Assignments
4	Tue. 09/15	Ch. 12: Investment (Session 3)	Post Ch. 12 (due 09/20)
4	Thu. 09/17	Ch. 15: (BAR) Leases (Session 1)	Pre Ch. 15 (due 09/17)
5	Tue. 09/22	Ch. 15: (BAR) Leases (Session 2)	
5	Thu. 09/24	Ch. 15: (BAR) Leases (Session 3)	Post Ch. 15 (due 09/27)
6	Tue. 09/29	Exam 1 self-preparation – No In-person Class	
6	Thu. 10/01	Exam 1 At home	AI 3 (due 10/04)
7	Tue. 10/06	Ch. 16: Income Taxes (Session 1)	Pre Ch. 16 (due 10/06)
7	Thu. 10/08	Ch. 16: Income Taxes (Session 2)	AI 4 (due 10/11)
8	Tue. 10/13	Ch. 16: Income Taxes (Session 3)	
8	Thu. 10/15	Ch. 16: Income Taxes (Session 4)	Post Ch. 16 (due 10/18)
9	Tue. 10/20	Ch. 17 (BAR) Pensions and Other Postretirement Benefits (Session 1)	Pre Ch. 17 (due 10/20)
9	Thu. 10/22	Ch. 17 (BAR) Pensions and Other Postretirement Benefits (Session 2)	Post Ch. 17 (due 10/25)
10	Tue. 10/27	Ch. 21: The Statement of Cash Flows (Session 1)	Pre Ch. 21 (due 10/27)
10	Thu. 10/29	Ch. 21: The Statement of Cash Flows (Session 2)	AI 5 (due 11/01)
11	Tue. 11/03	Ch. 21: The Statement of Cash Flows (Session 3)	Post Ch. 21 (due 11/08)
11	Thu. 11/05	Exam 2 self-preparation – No In-person Class	
12	Tue. 11/10	Exam 2 At home	
12	Thu. 11/12	Ch. 18: Shareholders' Equity (Session 1)	Pre Ch. 18 (due 11/12) AI 6 (due 11/15)
13	Tue. 11/17	Ch. 18: Shareholders' Equity (Session 2)	Post Ch. 18 (due 11/22)
13	Thu. 11/19	Ch. 19: (BAR) Share-based Compensation and EPS (Session 1)	Pre Ch. 19 (due 11/19)
14	Tue. 11/24	<i>Thanksgiving — No Class</i>	
14	Thu. 11/26	<i>Thanksgiving — No Class</i>	AI 7 (due 11/29)
15	Tue. 12/01	Ch. 19: (BAR) Share-based Compensation and EPS (Session 2)	
15	Thu. 12/03	Ch. 19: (BAR) Share-based Compensation and EPS (Session 3)	Post Ch. 19 (due 12/06)
Exam Week	Tue. 12/08	Final Comprehensive Exam At home	

*The above schedule, policies, procedures, and assignments in this course are subject to change in the event of extenuating circumstances, by mutual agreement, and/or to

ensure better student learning.

**“BAR” denotes that the topic is covered in the “Technical Accounting and Reporting” subsection of the “Business Analysis and Reporting” section of the CPA exam.

***This syllabus was prepared with the generous help of Li Wang and Yuxiang Zheng.

13 University Policies and Student Resources

13.1 Student Code of Conduct & Academic Misconduct

- **Code of Student Conduct:** The University of Akron stresses the importance of proper conduct inside and outside of the classroom. To foster an atmosphere conducive to learning, it is the responsibility of every student to know and follow the [Code of Student Conduct](#) and to conduct themselves in a manner that is appropriate for a collegiate educational environment. Behavior that is disruptive to teaching or learning or in violation of the Code of Student Conduct will be referred to the [Department of Student Conduct and Community Standards](#).
- **Academic Misconduct:** It is each student's responsibility to know what constitutes academic misconduct. The Code of Student Conduct defines academic misconduct as any activity that compromises the academic integrity of the student and university, and undermines the educational process. Academic misconduct includes, but is not limited to, cheating, plagiarism, and/or engaging in any behavior specifically prohibited by a faculty member in the course syllabus or during class discussion. Allegations of academic misconduct will be resolved following the [academic misconduct procedure](#) outlined in the Code of Student Conduct. For additional information or resources concerning academic misconduct, contact the Department of Student Conduct and Community Standards by phone at (330) 972-6380, by email at studentconduct@uakron.edu, or online at www.uakron.edu/studentconduct.
- **Course policy on Academic Dishonesty:** Any form of academic dishonesty on exams, projects, or homework assignments will result in zero points for that assignment or exam, and/or an “F” in the course, and will be formally referred to the University for disciplinary action.

13.2 Add, Drop, Withdrawal, and Refund Policies

All students must adhere to the University's policies on adding, dropping, and withdrawing from courses. The policies and important dates can be found at: - [Adding or dropping courses](#) - [Withdrawal Policy](#)

Please be aware that the date of a drop or withdrawal affects the amount of the refund. [See the University refund policy.](#)

13.3 Title IX & Sexual Misconduct

- **Title IX Statement:** Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972 prohibits sex discrimination against students, guests, and employees of educational institutions. The regulations implementing Title IX prohibit discrimination, exclusion, denial, limitation, or separation based on gender in all areas of education. More information is available on the [Title IX site](#).
- **Sexual Harassment and Sexual Violence:** The University of Akron is committed to providing an environment free of all forms of discrimination, including sexual violence and sexual harassment. If you (or someone you know) has experienced sexual violence or sexual harassment, help is available. Confidential help can be found at:
 - **Hope and Healing Survivor Center and Rape Crisis Center:** 24-hour Hotline: 330-434-7273 (Office located in the Student Recreation and Wellness Center 246; Campus Office: 330-972-6328). [Help for victims of sexual misconduct.](#)
 - **University Counseling and Testing Center:** 330-972-7082
 - **Student Health Services:** 330-972-7808
- **Reporting Requirement:** Please note that the majority of University of Akron employees, including faculty members, are considered “responsible employees” under the law and are required to report incidents of sexual harassment and sexual violence to the Title IX Coordinator and possibly the police.

13.4 Students with Disabilities (Office of Accessibility)

The University will make reasonable accommodations for persons with documented disabilities in order to promote student success and provide full access to the academic environment. If you have a documented disability, you are encouraged to contact the Office of Accessibility to register for services. You can reach the Office by email at access@uakron.edu, stop by Simmons Hall 105, or call 330-972-7928 or 330-972-5764 (TDD). More details can be found at [Office of Accessibility](#).

13.5 Religious Accommodations

Pursuant to Ohio Revised Code Section 3345.026 (the “Testing Your Faith Act”), you may request a religious accommodation to be excused from class up to three (3) days per

semester for reasons of faith or religious/spiritual belief systems to participate in organized activities. You will not be penalized for these excused absences. - The request must be made in writing during the first fourteen (14) days of the semester and include the date(s) of each proposed absence and the desired accommodation (e.g., alternate examination date). - An alternative examination date may be established, which may be before or after the original date. - For more information, contact the EEO Office (Administrative Services Building, 185 East Mill Street, Room 138, phone: 330-972-7300, email: EEOcompliance@uakron.edu) or visit [UA Religious Accommodations Policy](#).

13.6 ZipAssist

The University provides a variety of support programs and resources to ensure students are successful in and outside of the classroom. If you have trouble meeting basic needs like safe shelter, sleep, and food, or if you are seeking support related to tutoring, mental health, or navigating campus, please reach out to **ZipAssist** via the Help-A-Zip Referral Form at www.uakron.edu/referral or visit [ZipAssist](#).